

The Lighthouse - Access Levels Guide

Audience: Administrators, pastors, and coordinators who need to understand who can see and do what

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PDF: Access-Levels-Guide.pdf

How access works

The Lighthouse uses two layers of access control:

1. Base role - set on each person's account (Admin, Pastor, Member, or Visitor).
2. Module assignments - optional extras that grant coordinator, teacher, or bible-sharer capabilities within a specific module.

A cluster coordinator is typically a Member (or Pastor) who also has a Cluster -> Coordinator assignment.

Your branch (church location) further limits what data you see unless you are an Admin, an HQ Pastor, or an HQ Senior Coordinator.

Base roles

These are set when an administrator creates or edits a person under Account & Role.

Role	Can log in?	Typical use
Admin	Yes	Full system access; manages users, branches, module
Pastor	Yes	Pastoral oversight; broad read/write across modules
Member	Yes	Regular church member; read-mostly access unless giv
Visitor	No	Guest record only - tracked by staff, cannot sign in

What each base role can do (without module assignments)

Capability	Admin	Pastor	Member	Visitor
Log in	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
See disabled modules	Yes	No	No	-
Manage branches / module to	Yes	No	No	-
Assign module coordinators	Yes	No	No	-
People - view	All (incl. admins)	All except admins	Self + family	-
People - create/edit	Yes	Yes	Add visitors only	-
People - delete	Yes	Yes	No	-
Families - view	All	All (branch-scoped)	Own families	-
Clusters - view	All	All (branch-scoped)	Own cluster (read-only)	-
Module read access	All modules	All enabled modules	All enabled modules (limited c	-
Module write access	All	All enabled	Read only	-
Finance module	Yes	Yes	No	-
Analytics / Reports hub	Yes	Yes	No	-
Admin Settings	Yes	No	No	-

Module assignments overview

Administrators assign module access under Admin Settings -> Module Coordinators.

Each assignment has:

Field	Meaning
Person	Who receives the access (Admin accounts cannot be as
Module	Which area of the app (Cluster, Evangelism, Lessons,
Level	What kind of access within that module
Scope	Module-wide or limited to specific resources (e.g. o

A person can hold multiple assignments across different modules. Access is combined (you see the union of everything your assignments allow).

Available modules

Module	What it covers
Cluster	Small groups and weekly cluster reports
Evangelism	Bible study groups, prospects, conversion tracking
Lessons	New Converts Course (NCC)
Sunday School	Classes, enrollment, attendance
Events	Church calendar and occurrence attendance
Ministries	Ministry teams and rosters
Finance	Donations, offerings, pledges

Coordinator levels

Level	Summary
Senior Coordinator	Module-wide oversight; can delete records; sees bran
Coordinator	Leadership within a module; create and edit; may be
Teacher	Sunday School or Lessons instruction; edit own class
Bible Sharer	Evangelism group facilitation; edit assigned groups;

Per-module levels available

Module	Levels you can assign	Resource-specific scope?
Cluster	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator	Yes - pick cluster(s)
Evangelism	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator, Bible Sharer	Yes - pick evangelism group(s)
Lessons	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator, Teacher	Module-wide only
Sunday School	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator, Teacher	Yes - pick class(es)
Events	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator	Module-wide only
Ministries	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator	Module-wide only
Finance	Coordinator, Senior Coordinator	Module-wide only

Scope: module-wide vs resource-specific

Scope	Meaning
Module-wide (resource not set)	Access across the entire module within your branch (
Resource-specific	Access limited to selected clusters, evangelism grou

Example: A Cluster Coordinator scoped to "North Cluster" can manage and submit reports only for that cluster. A Cluster Senior Coordinator (module-wide) can oversee all clusters in their branch.

Cluster coordinator sync: When you set someone as coordinator on a cluster record, the system also creates a matching Cluster -> Coordinator module assignment for that cluster.

What module assignments add

Module assignments grant extra capabilities on top of your base role. They do not change your login role - the app checks both.

People and families visibility

When you have module assignments, you may see more people and families than a plain Member:

Assignment	People you can view	Families you can view
Senior Coordinator (any module)	All people except admins (branch-scoped)	All families in scope
Cluster Coordinator	Members of assigned cluster(s) + their families	Families linked to those clusters
Sunday School Teacher	Students in your class(es)	Families of those students
Lessons Teacher	Your lesson students	Families of those students
Bible Sharer	Members of assigned evangelism groups	Families of those members
Multiple assignments	Union of all the above	Union of all the above

People and families editing

Who	Create / edit people & families
Admin, Pastor	Yes (within branch scope)
Any module coordinator assignment	Yes (within visibility scope)
Plain Member	Add visitors only

Per-module actions

Action	Admin / Pastor	Senior Coordinator	Coordinator / Teacher / Bibl	Plain Member
Read module data	Yes	Yes	Yes (scoped)	Yes (limited)
Create / edit in module	Yes	Yes	Yes (scoped)	No
Delete in module	Yes	Yes (senior level)	No*	No

* Coordinators and teachers can create and edit but delete typically requires Senior Coordinator level (or Admin/Pastor).

Module-specific notes

Clusters

- Coordinators submit weekly reports for clusters they manage.
- Compliance tab is for senior cluster coordinators.
- Members see their own cluster read-only.

Evangelism

- Bible Sharers can edit groups they belong to; coordinators manage assigned groups.
- Weekly evangelism reports require evangelism coordinator access.

Lessons

- Teachers see and log sessions for their students.
- Coordinators assign lessons and see broader student lists.
- Branch filter on Lessons is editable for Admin, Pastor, and senior Lessons coordinators.

Sunday School

- Teachers manage attendance for their classes.
- Summary stats hidden from plain members.

Events

- Event coordinators create and edit events.
- Non-events senior coordinators may only edit events they created.

Ministries

- Ministry coordinators see ministries they are assigned to or listed on as primary/support coordinator.

Finance

- Page access is primarily Admin and Pastor; finance module coordinators support finance workflows where configured.

Branch scoping

Who	Branch visibility
Admin	All branches
Pastor at Headquarters	All branches
Pastor at regular branch	Own branch only
Senior Coordinator at HQ	All branches
Senior Coordinator at regular branch	Own branch only
Scoped coordinators / teachers	Own branch; data further limited by resource assignm
Member	Own branch; self + family + own cluster

Branch filters appear as chips or dropdowns on many pages. If a filter is locked, your role cannot view other branches.

Multiple assignments (common examples)

Person	Assignments	Effective access
Small-group leader	Member + Cluster Coordinator (Cluster A)	Submit reports for Cluster A; edit cluster members;
NCC teacher	Member + Lessons Teacher	Log lesson sessions; view assigned students
SS teacher + cluster lead	Member + Sunday School Teacher (Class 1) + Cl	Students in Class 1 plus Cluster B members and famil
Department head	Pastor + Evangelism Senior Coordinator	Full evangelism module in branch + pastoral people a
Finance volunteer	Member + Finance Coordinator	Finance module write access (page may still require

When assignments overlap, you always get the broadest combined view - never less than any single assignment would give alone.

Frontend: what you see in the app

The sidebar, dashboard cards, quick actions (+ menu), and stats panels adapt to your access:

- Disabled modules disappear from the sidebar (except for Admins).
- Stats / summary cards in Sunday School and Lessons are hidden from plain Members.
- Cluster page primary button is Add Cluster for admins, pastors, and senior cluster coordinators; other cluster coordinators see Submit Report as the main action.
- Analytics appears only for Admin and Pastor roles.
- Admin Settings appears only for Admins.

The app reads your assignments from your login profile - you do not pick a "coordinator mode."

Assigning access (admin quick steps)

1. Create the person with a login-capable base role (Member, Pastor, or Admin).
2. Go to Admin Settings -> Module Coordinators.
3. Create Assignment (one at a time) or Bulk assign (several resources or modules at once).
4. Choose person, module, level, and scope.
5. Verify with filters on the Module Coordinators list or the person's profile.

See the User Management Guide for step-by-step screenshots and password workflows.

Access evaluation order

When the system decides what you can see:

1. Admin / Pastor - broad access (with branch rules).
2. Senior Coordinator (any module) - broad people/families access in branch.
3. Multiple module assignments - union of all assignment scopes.
4. Single module assignment - limited to that module's scope.
5. Plain Member - self, family, own cluster (read-only).
6. Visitor - cannot log in.

Special rules:

- Admin accounts are hidden from non-admin user searches.
- Disabled modules block access for everyone except Admins.
- Resource-specific assignments always limit lists to those resources unless you also have a module-wide row for that module.

Troubleshooting access issues

Problem	Likely cause	Fix
User cannot submit cluster reports	No Cluster assignment for that cluster	Add Cluster -> Coordinator scoped to the cluster
User sees no one in People	Plain Member with no assignments	Expected - they only see self/family; add assignment
User needs coordinator access	No module assignments	Add assignments under Admin Settings -> Module Coord
Cannot see Finance page	Page restricted to Admin/Pastor	Change base role or use pastor account
Module missing from sidebar	Module disabled	Admin -> Module Controls -> enable module

Teacher cannot delete a record	Delete requires Senior Coordinator	Escalate to senior coordinator or pastor
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Quick reference matrix

I am a...	People edit	Cluster reports	Lessons assign	SS attendance	Events create
Admin	All	All	All	All	All
Pastor	All (branch)	All (branch)	All (branch)	All (branch)	All (branch)
Member	Visitors only	No	No	No	No
Cluster Coordinator	Scoped	Yes (scoped)	No	No	No
Cluster Senior Coord.	Branch-wide	All (branch)	No	No	No
Lessons Teacher	Students	No	No	No	No
Lessons Coordinator	Branch students	No	Yes	No	No
SS Teacher	Class students	No	No	Yes (class)	No
Evangelism Coord.	Group members	No	No	No	No
Bible Sharer	Group members	No	No	No	No

For full technical detail (API permissions, queryset rules), see ACCESS_CONTROL.md in the developer documentation.